

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 1406

By Powell

A RESOLUTION to honor and celebrate the Japan Men's National Team for selecting the State of Tennessee and Metropolitan Nashville to host its base camp and training site for the 2026 World Cup.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly are pleased to recognize a global sporting event that will contribute significantly to Tennessee's economy while entertaining soccer fans worldwide; and

WHEREAS, the Japan Men's National Team will use Nashville SC's Training Center in Antioch as its team base camp and training site in preparation for the FIFA 2026 World Cup this summer; and

WHEREAS, additionally, the Japanese Men's National Team and members of the Japan Football Association delegation will reside in Nashville when they are not traveling to World Cup host cities for matches; and

WHEREAS, spread across twelve acres and featuring 60,000 square feet of space, Nashville SC's Training Center is a world-class, state-of-the-art soccer complex that is home to three soccer fields, a full-service-dining hall, a theater-style video and film room, multiple cardio and weight-training areas, cryogenic chambers to aid in athlete recovery, and on-site medical facilities; and

WHEREAS, the Japanese Men's National Team's selection of Nashville for its 2026 World Cup base camp solidifies the Music City's reputation as a worldwide hub for soccer and emphasizes the city's importance in the global soccer landscape; and

WHEREAS, there is also an important economic component to Nashville hosting a base camp and training site for Japan, which is ranked 18th in the world by FIFA; and

WHEREAS, according to an analysis prepared for San Antonio, Texas's World Cup planning by Market Edge, non-host U.S. cities serving as an official FIFA training hub are projected to generate between \$5 million and \$15 million from a base camp arrangement; and

WHEREAS, the University of Tennessee will play an important role in the success of the first World Cup held on American soil since 1994; and

WHEREAS, because of its renowned turfgrass management program, the University of Tennessee was selected by FIFA to create the best natural grass playing surfaces at all sixteen host cities and dozens of training facilities across the U.S., Canada, and Mexico; and

WHEREAS, it is indeed exciting that the world's greatest sporting event is being contested on American soil this summer; it is equally exciting that the State of Tennessee and Metropolitan Nashville will play an important role in making the 2026 World Cup an event to cherish and remember; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor and celebrate the Japan Men's National Team and Japan Football Association for selecting the State of Tennessee and Metropolitan Nashville to host its base camp and training site for the 2026 World Cup and extend to them our warmest welcome to the Volunteer State and Music City USA.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.